

PRIVILEGED INSTRUCTIONS



FOREIGN, COMMONWEALTH
& DEVELOPMENT OFFICE
UNITED KINGDOM OF
GREAT BRITAIN
AND NORTHERN IRELAND

The Royal Coat of Arms of the United Kingdom is centered in the background. It features a shield supported by a lion on the left and a unicorn on the right. Above the shield is a crown. A banner at the bottom of the shield reads "DIEU ET MON DROIT".

PRIVILEGED INSTRUCTIONS



Foreign, Commonwealth & Development Office

Privileged Instructions

Fundamental Principle:

- Support the creation of a Unified Republic of Cyprus

Desired End States:

- A unified nation, politically equal and proportionally represented.
- A single nation within the European Community of nations.
- All Cypriot people freely invested a single Cypriot identity and heritage.
- A strong central government, politically stable, ethnically at peace, and fully representative of all Cypriots.
- A fully integrated Cyprus National Armed Forces providing for the nation's security.
- The end of all agreements that bind the Republic of Cyprus to any other nation or organization undertaken without the full consent of its people.

Delegation Instructions

Ensure periodic reports, requests for further guidance, or clarifications to the instructions herein are submitted via message to the office of the Foreign Secretary.

GENERAL: We have enjoyed excellent bilateral relations with the Republic of Cyprus based on our shared history and underpinned by mutual support for freedom, democracy, and peace. We support the peaceful settlement of disputes and their desire for a just and lasting solution to the Cyprus problem. A bicomunal, bizonal federation with a single sovereignty, single citizenship, and single international personality, with political equality is the desired end state.

- First and foremost, we must provide support to the SRSG and his efforts to facilitate and mediate a settlement. Assist efforts to move the Greek and Turkish Cypriot communities toward a final settlement. Deal directly with the nations of Greece and Türkiye to ensure that they do nothing to impede these negotiations, and secondly to assist both nations in a mutual reduction of tensions.
- We need to support EU efforts to balance between the Republic of Cyprus, as a member state, and its candidate state of Türkiye. While we do not have a direct role in EU affairs, we can represent EU positions to Türkiye to ensure that there is no misunderstanding of EU motives to underpin the compromises needed to ensure a settlement.
- Work with our friends from the United States in the coordination of our positions and possible measures that may aid the achievement of a solution.
- After coordination with the UN and U.S., work with the Greek and Turkish governments to resolve existent issues between the two nations themselves and any other issues that affect the two Cypriot communities.

- Finally, as appropriate, work with the Greek and Turkish Cypriot delegations to help facilitate steps toward a final comprehensive peace settlement.

GOVERNANCE

Turkish Cypriots advocate for a “virgin birth” for the formation of a new nation. A “United Republic of Cyprus” would cease any prior, internationally recognized, Republic of Cyprus and that this new country be born of two recognized and independent states, the “Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus” and the Republic of Cyprus.

Greek Cypriots counter that the Republic of Cyprus is already an internationally recognized state with membership in the UN and EU. Any undoing of this would create issues internationally. The Greek Cypriots reject the “virgin birth” proposal and feel that integration of the Turkish Cypriot community makes more sense.

We lean towards the Greek Cypriot side on this discussion but do not allow it to derail talks. Ultimately, we desire a united, peaceful, and self-protecting state.

POWER SHARING

Federal versus State: Greek Cypriots insist on a federation-style structure that delegates limited responsibilities to the constituent states. A strong central government with clear separation between national and state institutions and structures.

Turkish Cypriots strongly advocate for a confederation consisting of a weak federal government which resides a small number of national offices. They feel that strong communal state governments protect their constituencies from marginalization and oppression. Each state government would be able to better care for the needs of its constituents. The federal government would only deal with things such as banking, foreign service, and investigative services.

The Federal Executive: Greek Cypriots position is one of a popular vote for the office of President and Vice-President on “one ticket”. They feel that some form of weighted or cross-voting may ease Turkish Cypriots concerns to give them a full voice. The Greek Cypriot delegation may use this as a possible compromise area and may be a way to make a breakthrough.

Turkish Cypriots position is that a Senate-elected President and Vice-President, using a rotating system where each position is represented by different communities, is the only way to ensure proper checks on Greek Cypriot power. This is hinged on the make-up of the Senate being 50-50 to account for both community’s needs.

Both the role of the head of state and the government that they lead are crucial to a future unified state. See where there may be room for compromise so that both communities feel that the final representative government provides them with security and prosperity.

SECURITY AND GUARANTEES

The Treaty of Alliance and Treaty of Guarantee both form the basis for the formation of the Republic of Cyprus and ending the colonial past.

Greek Cypriots feel that both treaties would no longer be applicable to a new Cyprus state and should be terminated. The continuance of them we assess to be a deal breaker for them.

Turkish Cypriots feel that both treaties are required to maintain proper security and protection. We assess that they would agree to intervening force, whether Greek or Turkish, could be introduced as long as they are restricted to the limits of the corresponding constituent state.

The UN has proposed that both treaties be replaced with a new treaty. This proposal would encompass the Republic of Cyprus, Greece, and Türkiye. The concept of this treaty would be to encompass a set of different mechanisms for dealing with several different problems between the two communities. There may or may not be a military component and limitations or restrictions on potential interventions. Both parties appear to be open to this treaty concept.

POPULATION

The island's population has gone through significant changes since the 1974 invasion by Türkiye. An influx of Turkish settlers has drastically increased the population in the north. In order to deal with aspects of representation in a future government or voting policies an accurate census must be performed.

Greek Cypriots insist that before any negotiation on population is finalized an accurate census must be done. They insist on a neutral entity conduct and verify such census. Understanding the full population of the north that breaks down Turkish Cypriots, immigrants, and Turkish soldiers is required. Their goal is to return all Turkish soldiers and settlers, who they deem illegal immigrants, back to Türkiye as part of the overall settlement.

Turkish Cypriots also have concerns regarding settlers in their community. Their brethren from Türkiye are creating a situation where Turkish Cypriots are becoming a minority within their population. They are concerned that they will lose the character and uniqueness of what it is to be a Turkish Cypriot. Their controlling the definition of the term "settler" and suggesting the following criteria: 1. Resident on the island for over 15 years, 2. Has been formally accepted as a candidate for citizenship, 3. Owns property on Cyprus, and 4. Has no criminal record.

Another issue concerns the right of Greek Cypriots to live, own businesses, buy property, and vote in the Turkish Cypriot community. The current economic disparity between the Greek and Turkish Cypriot communities exacerbates the Turkish Cypriot hesitancy. Our position is one of concern for further marginalization of the Turkish Cypriots which would create pressure on a lasting peace. Limitations on the Greek Cypriots to exercise these rights should be explored.

CONFIDENCE BUILDING MEASURES

Confidence building must be a continuous process along with the other issues listed above. We must take the lead on resolving the below issues or talks will break down. Work these issues directly with the Greek and Turkish Cypriot delegations and bring the Americans in if you feel it constructive. If progress is being made, then you may approach Greece and Türkiye with any updates.

Direct Trade Regulation and Turkish EU Accession

With the 2004 accession of the Republic of Cyprus into the EU the European Commission approved a Direct Trade Regulation (DTR) that allowed Turkish Cypriots the privileged of direct export to EU member states at reduced customs rates. The Greek Cypriots immediately blocked implementation of the DTR by arguing that the regulation required the consensus of all EU member states. Their point was that by not using Greek Cypriot ports and payment of external EU custom and port duties that the EU was legitimizing the illegal state of the "Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus". In solidarity with their Turkish brethren Türkiye refused to implement provisions in the Ankara Protocol it had signed in 2005. The Republic of Cyprus ultimately blocked Türkiye's accession into the EU.

As former EU members we advocate for Türkiye's accession. Our government has gone back and forth on this stance. The suspension of accession talks in 2019 have to do with a variety of issues Türkiye needs to address but the Cyprus issue should be removed. Working with all sides to resolve this is only beneficial to all. This may be the step that changes the way Türkiye moves forward with EU accession talks.

Varosha, Famagusta Port and Ercan Airport

Greek Cypriots value Varosha and have longed for its return to their control. Turkish Cypriots hold Varosha as a bargaining chip for future settlement. The suburban coastal area was developed into one of the most attractive tourist locations in the Mediterranean. It has fallen into disrepair, but Turkish Cypriots have slowly attempted to reopen the area for development since 2020. Offers for redevelopment, for Greek Cypriot owners of properties seized during the partitioning of the island, have been empty as the Turkish Cypriots demand continued control of the city. Thus, Greek Cypriots have rejected these offers.

Try to find common ground on Varosha. The years of disrepair and recent redevelopment cause concern for both sides. Greek Cypriot property owners deserve some compensation for their loss but at the same time Turkish Cypriots who have redeveloped the area should not be penalized for their efforts. Balancing this issue will require creative actions on your part.

Famagusta is the surrounding town of Varosha. The Turkish Cypriots desire to open this port up for trade under EU, or UN, supervision. They feel that this will open up trade for some Greek Cypriots with Türkiye and also help ease their economic difficulties.

Ercan Airport is located in the Turkish Cypriot area. The Greek Cypriots refuse to recognize its existence as a viable port of entry into Cyprus. With the TRNC not being internationally recognized they cannot authorize international recognition of the airport. Only direct flights between Türkiye and Ercan are currently flown. Greek Cypriots have acted against direct flights from states other than Türkiye and vow to continue to do so. In 2005 they had issue with a single direct flight from Baku, Azerbaijan.

We support both Famagusta and Ercan Airport being recognized as international ports of entry. If EU or UN control eases the Greek Cypriot case, then work towards establishing this. Resolving this issue may remove Greek Cypriot blocks on Türkiye's accession bid and can restart talks within the EU.

Note: The United States Government does not recognize the "Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus." Usage of the terms "Turkish Republic of Northern Cyprus" and "TRNC" in this exercise, being administered by the United States Army War College, is used for educational purposes only and does not reflect a contradiction to the United States Government official stance.